

Tab 1

CAPSTON PRD

Create a team name! (optional)

FLON

Please provide a finalized proposal for your team's Capstone Project. It should be 3-4 sentences addressing the problem, proposed solution, and the scope of what you'd like to achieve throughout the semester.

Finn's Proposal:

Nura's Proposal:

Otto's Proposal

Otto's Proposal:

Prompted Claude with this:

I'm thinking of an app for busy students, that basically takes all the information from your GCal, gmail, canvas, whatever applications students use, and turns it into a sort of daily briefer in podcast form -- like the nytimes "the daily" but personalized to you, helping you sort out your priorities and help remember your schedule and what you have coming up. Furthermore, when there's something specific (i.e. a big midterm, an interview, a club application, really anything you want to learn) coming up, you can prompt the app to focus on that and teach it to you in a podcast form; the user would feed the app the relevant readings and assignment material, and the app (AI) would respond and try to teach the content, either in "lecture" mode where it just teaches you the content, in "podcast" mode where its two people in conversation about the topic, or in response mode, where it prompts the user for verbal responses. the idea of making this into a sort of auditory form instead of written is for the large population of students who want to use their very limited time more efficiently. Possible users would be people who have lengthy morning routines and would put their "daily" on, from girls who do their makeup to guys who shower and brush their teeth and want something to listen to. Additionally, athletes and people who go to the gym regularly and want to remain consistent but also don't want to miss out on studying can listen to the podcast while they work out, killing two birds with one stone -- in this case, the audience isn't just all existing athletes, but there's a potential untapped group of students who want to work out more consistently but are constantly doing other things such as studying and therefore can't go to the gym as much as they'd like, something this app would remedy. These are just rough thoughts, there are other ways and features we can add to gamify the experience -- daily streaks or combining with friends for instance .

The idea is that the app helps make your life more efficient, organized, and structured.

This was the output, which I think is pretty good and matches what I had in mind. Don't really fw the name though but we can change it:

EarlyBird — Your AI-Powered Audio Study Companion

Product Proposal v0.1

Summary:

EarlyBird is an AI-powered audio platform that transforms a student's schedule, deadlines, and course materials into personalized, on-demand audio — a daily briefing that runs through your priorities each morning like a smart radio show, and a study engine that can teach you anything in podcast, lecture, or interactive quiz form. Instead of asking students to carve out more desk time they don't have, EarlyBird fits inside the time they're already spending — getting ready, commuting, working out — turning dead hours into the most productive part of the day. With

integrations across Google Calendar, Gmail, Canvas, and more, it knows what's coming up, what matters most, and what you need to learn, then delivers it straight to your ears.

The Problem

Students today face a brutal paradox: they have more information to absorb than ever before, and less uninterrupted time to do it. Between classes, jobs, clubs, workouts, and social lives, the average college student loses hours every day to "dead time" — the morning routine, the commute, the gym — moments where their eyes and hands are occupied but their ears are completely free.

Meanwhile, traditional study tools demand exactly what students don't have: a quiet desk, open laptop, and full attention. The result? Students fall behind, sacrifice sleep, skip workouts, and burn out.

EarlyBird flips the model. Instead of demanding your time, it fits inside the time you already have.

The Product

EarlyBird is an AI-powered audio platform for students that transforms your schedule, coursework, and priorities into personalized, on-demand audio — a daily briefing, a study podcast, a lecture, or an interactive verbal quiz, all generated around *you*.

Think of it as *The Daily* by the New York Times, but instead of world news, it's your world: your deadlines, your readings, your exam next Thursday.

Core Features

1. The Daily Briefing

Every morning, EarlyBird generates a personalized audio digest by pulling from your connected apps — Google Calendar, Gmail, Canvas, Notion, and more. The briefing covers:

- What's on your schedule today and this week
- Upcoming deadlines, exams, and meetings
- Email highlights and urgent flags
- A priority stack: what you actually need to focus on today

The tone is crisp and conversational — not robotic. Think morning radio, not a screen reader.

Example: *"Good morning. You've got Econ lecture at 10, office hours at 2, and soccer practice at 5. Your Poli Sci paper is due Friday — you haven't started the third section yet. Tonight's your best window. You also have three unread emails from your professor, one marked urgent."*

2. Deep Dive Study Mode

When something big is coming up — a midterm, a job interview, a club application, a licensing exam — users can switch into Study Mode. They upload the relevant materials (lecture slides, readings, syllabi, notes), and EarlyBird uses AI to teach the content back to them in audio form. Three formats:

Lecture Mode A single AI host teaches the material end-to-end, structured like a real lecture. Ideal for first-pass learning or when you just need the content delivered clearly.

Podcast Mode Two AI hosts discuss the material conversationally — debating key arguments, asking each other questions, working through difficult concepts together. This format mirrors how humans naturally learn through dialogue, making abstract ideas stickier.

Response Mode (Active Recall) The AI quizzes you verbally. It asks a question, waits, listens to your spoken answer, and responds with feedback, corrections, or follow-up questions. This is the closest EarlyBird gets to a real tutor — and it's the most effective for retention.

Users can mix and match modes across different subjects or switch mid-session.

3. Contextual Smart Prompting

EarlyBird doesn't just respond to uploads — it notices context. If your calendar shows a midterm in 48 hours, it surfaces a prompt: *"Want me to put together a study session on Organic Chemistry before Thursday?"* It connects the dots between your schedule and your uploaded course materials so you don't have to.

4. Streak & Progress System

Consistency is the hardest part of studying. EarlyBird gamifies engagement through:

- **Daily Streaks** — listen to your briefing or complete a study session every day to maintain your streak
- **Subject Mastery Bars** — track progress per course as you complete study sessions
- **Weekly Recaps** — an audio summary every Sunday: what you covered, what's coming, and what you're behind on
- **Milestone Badges** — first week streak, first active recall session, first exam prep completed

These are deliberately lightweight — motivating without being manipulative.

Target Users

The Morning Routine Crowd

Students who spend 20–40 minutes getting ready every morning and currently listen to music or nothing. EarlyBird gives that time academic ROI without changing a single habit. The daily briefing drops in exactly like a podcast episode.

Athletes & Gym-Goers

Student athletes and fitness-focused students face a specific version of the time crunch: every hour at the gym feels like an hour stolen from studying. EarlyBird resolves this completely — a 45-minute workout becomes a 45-minute study session in Lecture or Podcast Mode. Importantly, this also unlocks a *new* user segment: students who *want* to work out consistently but feel they can't justify the time away from their desks. EarlyBird removes that excuse. Working out is no longer competing with studying — it enables it.

The Commuter

Students who take public transit, drive, or bike to campus. Dead commute time becomes prep time.

The Overwhelmed Generalist

Students managing many courses, extracurriculars, and part-time jobs who feel perpetually behind. The daily briefing alone — surfacing priorities and deadlines in a clear, human voice — provides meaningful anxiety reduction and organizational clarity.

Integration Ecosystem

EarlyBird connects to the tools students already use:

Platform	What EarlyBird Pulls
Google Calendar	Schedule, events, reminders
Gmail	Emails, flags, professor messages
Canvas / Blackboard	Assignments, deadlines, syllabi
Notion / Obsidian	Notes, to-do lists, reading lists
Spotify / Apple Music	Knows when you're listening — pauses briefing if music is playing
iCal / Outlook	Additional calendar sources

Setup should take under five minutes via OAuth — no manual configuration.

Potential Additional Features (Roadmap)

Collaborative Study Pods — two or more students can generate a shared podcast episode on a topic, with both of their uploaded materials synthesized together. Built-in social accountability.

Spaced Repetition Audio — EarlyBird tracks what you've studied and re-surfaces review questions in future sessions based on spaced repetition principles, the gold standard for long-term retention.

Sleep Mode — a gentle audio review of tomorrow's priorities played at low volume as an optional wind-down. Passive reinforcement without screen exposure.

Class Recording Ingestion — students upload or sync lecture recordings; EarlyBird summarizes them and folds key points into the next study session.

Pre-Interview Mode — specialized for recruiting season. Feed EarlyBird a job description and your resume; it runs verbal mock interviews with live feedback.

New Feature Blurbs

Meeting & Office Hours Recording

The product includes an in-app recording feature that captures conversations — office hours with a professor, a club meeting, a study group session, or a work call — and automatically transcribes them. For academic use, this means feedback given verbally by a professor gets pulled into the product's study plan, surfacing action items and notes in the next daily briefing without the user having to write anything down. For professional contexts, it solves the common problem of verbal decisions and next steps getting lost after a meeting ends: the transcript is stored, searchable, and any relevant reminders are woven directly into the next day's briefing. Nothing said out loud falls through the cracks.

Transcript Library & Daily One-Pager

Beyond audio, the product also functions as a centralized personal knowledge hub. Every transcript — from recordings, uploaded readings, or study sessions — is stored and searchable in one place, giving users a running archive of everything they've engaged with. Alongside the audio briefing, the product generates a concise daily one-pager: a clean, skimmable text summary of the day's priorities, deadlines, and any relevant notes or follow-ups from recent recordings. This makes the product useful not just while you're in motion, but also during the brief moments when you sit down and want a fast written snapshot of where things stand.

Why Now

A few converging trends make this the right moment:

- AI voice generation has become indistinguishable from human speech at scale
- Students are more audio-native than any previous generation (podcasts, audiobooks, voice memos)
- The mental health and burnout crisis on campuses is well-documented — tools that reduce friction and cognitive load have genuine demand
- No current product owns the "audio-first studying" category; it's wide open

Summary

EarlyBird is a new kind of study tool — one that doesn't ask students to sit down and focus, but instead meets them where they already are: in motion, in routine, in the in-between moments

that currently go to waste. It's personalized, audio-first, and built around the reality of student life rather than an idealized version of it.

The opportunity is simple: turn dead time into the most productive part of the day.

Proposal v0.1 — for internal review and iteration

one pager

AI-Powered Audio Study Companion

The Opportunity

Students lose hours every day to dead time: morning routines, commutes, workouts. These are moments where their ears are free but their minds go unused. Traditional study tools demand a quiet desk and full attention. Our product captures that lost time instead.

What We're Building

The product transforms a student's schedule, deadlines, and course materials into personalized, on-demand audio. Each morning, it generates a smart briefing by pulling from Google Calendar, Gmail, and Canvas, surfacing priorities, flagging deadlines, and reading the day aloud like a radio host, not a screen reader. When exams or interviews loom, students upload their materials and EarlyBird teaches the content back in three formats: Lecture (one host, structured delivery), Podcast (two hosts in dialogue), or Response Mode (verbal active recall with live AI feedback). A streak and progress system keeps engagement consistent without manipulation.

Who We're Building It For

The target user works out, commutes, or spends 30 minutes getting ready every morning. Right now, that time produces nothing. The product gives it academic ROI without changing a single habit. Athletes, commuters, and overwhelmed multi-taskers all share the same core problem: more to learn, less time to sit down.

Why Now

AI voice generation now sounds human. Students already consume podcasts and audiobooks natively. Campus burnout rates are rising, and demand for low-friction study tools is real. No product currently owns the audio-first studying category. That space sits wide open.

Next Steps

We need to pressure-test the idea against reality. That means mapping the competitive landscape, identifying technical constraints early (voice latency, LLM integration, OAuth complexity), and building a feedback list of students, professors, and people in tech to stress-test assumptions before we build.

But the core thesis holds: students have time they aren't using. We can create a product to use it more efficiently.

Idea Doc

Name:

Mentor: Zoe Wang

1. Problem Statement

What significant problem or need have you identified? (2-3 sentences)

The rate my professor app provides inaccurate and biased information about professors and their class. It also doesn't have the most helpful information and missing elements like a syllabus from the class.

Why is this problem worth solving? (1-2 sentences)

This problem is worth solving because the app has so much potential to help students find the courses that are worth taking in their 4 years of college.

2. Product Concept

Provide a high-level description of your proposed solution. (2-3 sentences)

I want to

How does your solution address the identified problem? (1-2 sentences)

My solution streamlines access to university information for Hoyas, making their lives easier by keeping information organized and helping them to navigate the many resources that Georgetown offers to them as students at this institution.

3. Target Audience

Who would benefit most from your product? Be as specific as possible. (1-2 sentences)

Hoyas would most benefit from my product because all of the information stored and accessible within the app would be related to Georgetown University. However, it's possible that the format of the app could be used as a skeleton for other universities and would standardize the industry of Official University applications.

4. Unique Value Proposition

What makes your idea innovative or different from existing solutions? (2-3 sentences)

I've yet to find an Official University app that contains all university related information in one app. Harvard has a "Library Checkout " and "Recreation" app but doesn't seem to have a centralized organizational application. Stanford has an official app with an excess of features like the weather in Stanford, but it also has a "Rec and Well" and "Stanford Cardinal" apps. At Georgetown, we have a "Georgetown Hoyas" in addition to the Georgetown App which has an awful user interface. My idea is innovative because it will organize information in a centralized location that makes the information efficiently accessible to Hoyas. However, it also has the potential to inspire a skeleton for Official University Apps among top institutions, making the lives of college students much easier.

5. Initial Thoughts on Feasibility

What are your initial thoughts on the feasibility of developing this idea over the semester? (1-2 sentences)

I think it's very possible to develop this idea. Most of it is related to design (replacing icons with modernized icons, spacing, buttons, etc.).

The most difficult and perhaps least feasible aspect of the idea over the semester would be connecting university resources to the app. For example, instead of a click on the "Georgetown map" sending users to a link of a georgetown map, having the information from the webpage translated by the app into a standardized format that keeps everything in one place.

6. Personal Connection (Optional)

Do you have any personal experience with this problem or motivation for solving it? (1-2 sentences)

When I enrolled at Georgetown, I checked the app store and searched up "Georgetown" to see what would come up. When I saw that there was an official Georgetown app, I downloaded it without hesitation. My first time on the app lasted about 15 seconds because the user interface was disgusting and I clicked on "Georgetown Map" and saw it was just a bunch of links in one place. Quickly I realized that the app was poorly designed, inefficient, and hadn't used nor heard of the app among students since I downloaded it myself. Also, in one of the Product Space Fellowship Classes, when Anish asked us if we had any ideas, I said I was thinking

about working on the Georgetown app. What took me by surprise was that one of my peers hadn't heard of the app in the first place!

User Personas

User Persona Template

Fill out each section with relevant, realistic details based on your user research. Ensure the persona represents a key segment of your target audience. Use this persona to guide product decisions and feature prioritization. Update the persona as you gather more user insights throughout the project. Remember, the goal is to create a realistic representation of your target user, not an idealized version. Include both positive and negative traits that are relevant to your product.

Basic Information

- Name: Jordan Mitchell
- Age: 29
- Occupation: Marketing Manager
- Location: Austin, Texas, USA

Photo

[Insert a representative image or avatar]

Background

[Write a brief paragraph (2-3 sentences) about the person's background, including relevant personal or professional history]

Jordan has been working in marketing for five years, balancing a demanding job with a busy social life. Jordan started using MyFitnessPal 2 years ago after deciding he wanted to lose weight, and began strength training half a year ago. Jordan wants to start getting more consistent with his weightlifting by starting to track his reps and weight lifted.

Goals and Motivations

- Primary Goal: improve strength and muscle over the next year
- Secondary Goal: maintain a balanced diet that supports building strength and weight goals
- Motivation: Jordan is driven by personal fitness milestones and the desire to feel strong and confident. Staying organized and having clear data to review progress is motivating.

Frustrations and Pain Points

- 1) Difficulty tracking strength training progress in MyFitnessPal
- 2) The current exercise logging feature is too focused on cardio and doesn't help with weightlifting tracking

- 3) Manually tracking weight, sets, and repetitions outside the app is tedious and time-consuming

Technology Proficiency

Jordan is comfortable with technology and frequently uses fitness apps, social media, and productivity tools. Jordan also uses technology at work. Jordan uses various tools at work to manage marketing campaigns, analyze data, and communicate with teams.

Behaviors and Habits

Logs meals and calories frequently using MyFitnessPal; works out at the gym a few times per week, with a mix of weightlifting and cardio, tracks workouts and progress manually in a notebook or separate app due to lack of weightlifting tracking features in MyFitnessPal.

Preferred Channels

Jordan tends to seek information through a mix of online research, social media, and word of mouth. Jordan also values recommendations from friends and colleagues, especially when it comes to discovering new tools or solutions.

Quote

"I love tracking my calories with MyFitnessPal, but I wish it could track my weightlifting progress as easily as it tracks my meals."

How Our Product Helps

The new strength training tracking feature would allow Jordan to log and visualize weightlifting progress directly within MyFitnessPal, making it easier to see improvements in strength over time. By integrating this into the app Jordan already uses daily for diet tracking, it eliminates the need for separate tools or manual tracking, simplifying their fitness routine.

Scenario

After finishing a weightlifting session, Jordan opens the new exercise tracking tab in MyFitnessPal to log the sets, weights, and reps for each exercise. Over time, Jordan can easily track trends in strength gains and compare progress using visual graphs that chart out personal

records for different lifts. This not only keeps Jordan motivated but also helps plan future workouts based on data insights.

Busy Student

User Persona 1: The Busy Student

Basic Information

- Name: Maya Chen
- Age: 20
- Occupation: Sophomore, Government/Econ double major
- Location: New Haven, Connecticut

Photo

Background

Maya is a full-time student at a competitive university, balancing two demanding majors alongside a part-time campus job and involvement in two student organizations. She went to a similarly competitive high school and puts significant pressure on herself academically, but has struggled to build sustainable study habits as her course load has intensified. She often feels reactive rather than organized, well aware that deadlines are coming but unclear on how to sequence her time.

Goals and Motivations

- *Primary Goal:* Stay on top of readings and assignments and prepare for career recruiting.
- *Secondary Goal:* Reduce decision fatigue around what to work on and when and succeed in clubs.
- *Motivation:* Maya is driven by academic performance and the desire to feel in control of her schedule. She responds well to structure and gets anxious when things feel scattered. Knowing she's prepared for what's ahead gives her peace of mind.

Frustrations and Pain Points

- 1) Switching between Canvas, Google Calendar, Gmail, Slack, and her notes app means important deadlines regularly slip through
- 2) She has no shortage of study time in theory, but consistently loses it to indecision about what to prioritize
- 3) Traditional study methods require her full attention at a desk, which conflicts with her packed schedule
- 4) She forgets some verbal information from professors and in meetings after office hours end

Technology Proficiency

Maya is highly comfortable with technology and uses a wide range of productivity and academic tools daily. She's an early adopter by habit and frequently tries new apps looking for something that actually fits her workflow (think Notion because she heard about it from her friends, lots of AI tools) though she's also quick to drop tools that require too much manual upkeep.

Behaviors and Habits

Checks email first thing every morning; keeps a rough to-do list in her notes app that she updates inconsistently; usually spends 45 min - 1 hr getting ready in the morning or for going out; spends Sunday evenings trying to mentally map out the week ahead; frequently studies with background music (think jazz or classical).

Preferred Channels

Word of mouth from friends and classmates is the primary discovery channel, which she's used to from her high school and in college crowdsourcing strategies for managing a rigorous academic life. She also follows productivity and student life content on TikTok and YouTube (watched all those college admissions people on TikTok in high school and now watches that one guy who won't shut up about finance + other career-specific FYP content creators), and responds well to app recommendations embedded in campus communities (clubs) or academic newsletters.

Quote

"I know everything that's due, I just never know what to actually do right now. And when I figure it out, I've already wasted an hour."

How Our Product Helps

The product aggregates Maya's Canvas assignments, Slack, calendar, and email into a single daily briefing she can listen to while getting ready, giving her a clear priority stack before she's even left her room. When a big exam or paper is approaching, she can upload her readings and have the product teach her the material while she walks to class or goes on the Stairmaster. Office hours feedback gets recorded and integrated into her study plan automatically.

Scenario

It's Wednesday morning and Maya has a midterm in two days on Friday. While doing her skincare routine, she plays that morning's briefing: it runs through her day's schedule, flags the midterm, and surfaces two unread emails from her professor with clarifications posted to Canvas. The app recommends she start to review the material. She switches into Podcast Mode for her twenty-minute walk to class, where two AI hosts break down the lecture material she

uploaded the night before. By the time she sits down in her first class, she has a structured approach to her day while feeling productive.

Student Athlete

User Persona 2: The Student Athlete

Basic Information

- Name: Alex Parker
- Age: 29
- Occupation: Junior, Communications major
- Location: Durham, NC

Photo

Background

Alex is a scholarship athlete whose sport is effectively a second full-time job. Between practice, film sessions, travel, and strength training, he logs 25-30 hours per week in athletic obligations on top of a full courseload. He's personable and organized by nature but operates under a unique level of time scarcity that most students don't experience. Academic resources at his university technically exist for athletes, but they assume he has flexible afternoons and quiet evenings, which he almost never does (likes to go out, is in some social clubs, thinking about a part-time job for spending cash).

Goals and Motivations

- *Primary Goal:* Do well athletically while maintaining academic eligibility by excelling with coursework instead of just scraping by
- *Secondary Goal:* Use the product during workouts and travel to reclaim study time that would otherwise be completely lost
- *Motivation:* Alex has professional aspirations beyond college basketball and knows his GPA and academic engagement matter. He's also competitive by nature. He takes streaks to maintain or a progress bar to fill seriously.

Frustrations and Pain Points

- 1) Road trips and away games can wipe out two to three days of study time with no viable alternative
- 2) Team schedules are released and revised constantly, making personal planning difficult
- 3) He falls behind on readings and has no time to catch up using traditional methods
- 4) Study groups and tutoring sessions are almost never scheduled around athletic commitments

Technology Proficiency

Comfortable with technology and uses it naturally for communication, film review, and scheduling. Less inclined to explore new apps on his own but will commit fully once he sees clear value. Prefers tools that work with minimal setup and don't require him to build new habits.

Behaviors and Habits

Has AirPods in almost constantly during warmups, in the gym, on the team bus, and in hotel rooms before away games. Uses his phone to manage most of his life. Will rarely sit at a desk voluntarily. Responds better to audio and visual content over reading. Has a genuine desire to perform academically but needs a better study format.

Preferred Channels

Primarily influenced by teammates and trusted peers. Coaches and academic advisors at athletic programs are also an opportunity since a tool gets recommended or adopted at the program level, uptake among athletes is high.

Quote

"I'm on a bus to an away game right now. I have a paper due Monday and we don't get back until Sunday night. Where am I supposed to study?"

How Our Product Helps

The product turns every hour Alex spends in transit or the gym into usable study time. Lecture Mode lets him move through dense readings while lifting; Podcast Mode makes long bus rides academically productive; Response Mode gives him active recall practice during stretching or recovery sessions. The daily briefing synthesizes his athletic and academic calendar together so he doesn't have to juggle mentally between two separate schedules. Streaks and other gamification features give him a competitive hook that fits his personality.

Scenario

It's Thursday afternoon and Alex's team bus is three hours into a road trip. He plugs in his AirPods and opens the product's briefing, which reminds him that his Communications paper outline is due Monday and that he has an econ quiz when he gets back Tuesday. He switches to Podcast Mode for the paper's assigned readings and two AI hosts discuss the key arguments while he reclines in his seat. He flags two points he wants to use in his paper using the in-app voice note feature. By the time the bus pulls into the hotel, he's recapped his reading for the week.

Busy Professional

User Persona 3: Busy Professional

Basic Information

- Name: Priya Anand
- Age: 27
- Occupation: Second-year Associate, Management Consulting
- Location: Chicago, Illinois

Photo

Background

Priya works at a large consulting firm where 60-hour weeks are regular and client deliverables are constant. She's sharp and very ambitious, but the volume of information she's expected to track as an associate, including internal meetings, client calls, project updates, emails, and industry reading, has started to feel overwhelming. She's tried various productivity systems and apps over the years but has abandoned most of them.

Goals and Motivations

- *Primary Goal:* Feel on top of her workload and prepared for every meeting without having to spend hours synthesizing information manually
- *Secondary Goal:* Reclaim some personal time and mental capacity, she wants to exercise and read more consistently but feels she can't justify the time away
- *Motivation:* Priya is motivated by professional competence from her competitive and prestigious background and the feeling of being the most prepared person in the room. She also has a strong desire to feel less overwhelmed.

Frustrations and Pain Points

- 1) Verbal decisions made in client meetings get lost and frequently need to be re-litigated because no one has a record
- 2) Her mornings are rushed and she arrives at the office already behind on context
- 3) She wants to work out more consistently but the gym always loses to work when time is short
- 4) Industry reading and professional development fall completely off when projects get intense

Technology Proficiency

High. Priya uses Slack, Notion, Google Workspace, Zoom, Microsoft Suite and several client-specific tools daily. She's discerning about new tools and values reliability and professionalism over novelty.

Behaviors and Habits

Commutes 35 minutes each way on the train; listens to news podcasts or music in the morning while getting ready; keeps a running list of to-dos in Notion that she reviews inconsistently; takes notes during meetings but rarely has time to synthesize them; goes to the gym on weekends when she can but has pretty much given up on weekday workouts.

Preferred Channels

Professional peer networks, LinkedIn, and internal word of mouth at her firm. She's receptive to tools recommended by respected colleagues. B2B or firm-level adoption is a realistic pathway.

Quote

"I want to lead a healthier lifestyle and work out more, but I can't miss out on work priorities."

How Our Product Helps

The product's morning briefing synthesizes Priya's calendar, emails, and Slack highlights into a five-minute audio rundown she listens to while getting ready and on the train. Meeting recordings capture verbal decisions and surface them as reminders in the next briefing. The daily one-pager gives her a text snapshot she can glance at to keep her day structured. She can go to the gym while effectively preparing for work.

Scenario

Priya's alarm goes off at 6:45. While she gets ready, she plays the day's briefing: it covers her three meetings, flags that a client follow-up from yesterday's call is still unresolved, and summarizes two industry articles relevant to a proposal she's working on. On her commute, she switches to a focused audio summary of the proposal's key research (from a file she uploaded the night before.) That evening, she goes to the gym and listens to a briefing on a new framework she needs to understand for a workshop Friday.

PRD

Reverb — Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Project Overview

Title

Reverb

Introduction

Students, athletes, and professionals today face a shared paradox: the volume of information they're expected to absorb keeps growing, while the uninterrupted time available to process it keeps shrinking. Between classes, practices, commutes, morning routines, and back-to-back meetings, the hours that could be spent learning, reviewing, and organizing are constantly being crowded out; not because people are lazy, but because traditional tools demand focused desk time that most people just don't have.

Reverb is an AI-powered audio platform that transforms a user's schedule, deadlines, coursework, and meeting notes into personalized, on-demand audio. Every morning, Reverb delivers a smart daily briefing, synthesized from the user's GCal, email, Canvas, and Slack (or other tools like Notion or Outlook), that runs through priorities, flags what's coming, and surfaces anything urgent, all in the time it takes to get ready. When something important is on the horizon, users can switch into Study Mode and have Reverb teach them the relevant material in podcast, lecture, or interactive quiz form. And because every session, transcript, and recording lives in one searchable hub, nothing said or learned ever gets lost. Where most productivity tools stop at awareness, Reverb closes the loop with an AI-powered Action Stack that breaks your workload into realistic work blocks and actively prompts you throughout the day on what to do next.

Reverb doesn't ask users to change their habits. It fits inside the time they're already spending and makes it count.

User Persona: The Busy Student

Basic Information

- Name: Maya Chen
- Age: 20
- Occupation: Sophomore, Government/Econ double major

- Location: New Haven, Connecticut

Photo

Background

Maya is a full-time student at a competitive university, balancing two demanding majors alongside a part-time campus job and involvement in two student organizations. She went to a similarly competitive high school and puts significant pressure on herself academically, but has struggled to build sustainable study habits as her course load has intensified. She often feels reactive rather than organized, well aware that deadlines are coming but unclear on how to sequence her time.

Goals and Motivations

- *Primary Goal:* Stay on top of readings and assignments and prepare for career recruiting.
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- *Motivation:* Maya is driven by academic performance and the desire to feel in control of her schedule. She responds well to structure and gets anxious when things feel scattered. Knowing she's prepared for what's ahead gives her peace of mind.

Frustrations and Pain Points

- 1) Switching between Canvas, Google Calendar, Gmail, Slack, and her notes app means important deadlines regularly slip through
- 2) She has no shortage of study time in theory, but consistently loses it to indecision about what to prioritize
- 3) Traditional study methods require her full attention at a desk, which conflicts with her packed schedule
- 4) She forgets some verbal information from professors and in meetings after office hours end

Technology Proficiency

Maya is highly comfortable with technology and uses a wide range of productivity and academic tools daily. She's an early adopter by habit and frequently tries new apps, looking for something that actually fits her workflow (think Notion because she heard about it from her friends, lots of AI tools), though she's also quick to drop tools that require too much manual upkeep.

Behaviors and Habits

Checks email first thing every morning; keeps a rough to-do list in her notes app that she updates inconsistently; usually spends 45 min - 1 hr getting ready in the morning or for going out; spends Sunday evenings trying to mentally map out the week ahead; frequently studies with background music (think jazz or classical).

Preferred Channels

Word of mouth from friends and classmates is the primary discovery channel, which she's used to from her high school and in college, crowdsourcing strategies for managing a rigorous academic life. She also follows productivity and student life content on TikTok and YouTube (watched all those college admissions people on TikTok in high school and now watches that one guy who won't shut up about finance + other career-specific FYP content creators), and responds well to app recommendations embedded in campus communities (clubs) or academic newsletters.

Quote

"I know everything that's due, I just never know what to actually do right now. And when I figure it out, I've already wasted an hour."

How Our Product Helps

The product aggregates Maya's Canvas assignments, Slack, calendar, and email into a single daily briefing she can listen to while getting ready, giving her a clear priority stack before she's even left her room. When a big exam or paper is approaching, she can upload her readings and have the product teach her the material while she walks to class or goes on the Stairmaster. Office hours feedback gets recorded and integrated into her study plan automatically.

Scenario

It's Wednesday morning, and Maya has a midterm in two days on Friday. While doing her skincare routine, she plays that morning's briefing: it runs through her day's schedule, flags the midterm, and surfaces two unread emails from her professor with clarifications posted to Canvas. The app recommends she start to review the material. She switches into Podcast Mode for her twenty-minute walk to class, where two AI hosts break down the lecture material she uploaded the night before. By the time she sits down in her first class, she has a structured approach to her day while feeling productive.

Market Analysis

Competitor Analysis

The audio productivity space has no direct competitor to Reverb, but adjacent products occupy parts of the problem space. Notion AI and other AI writing assistants help users organize information, but are entirely text-based and require active engagement at a screen. Podcast apps like Spotify and Apple Podcasts deliver audio content but are entirely static because they have no awareness of a user's schedule, priorities, or coursework. Tools like Otter.ai and Fireflies offer meeting transcription but stop there, with no synthesis, briefing, or study functionality built on top. Academic tools like Canvas and Google Classroom manage assignments and deadlines, but make no attempt to help students actually process or retain the material. NotebookLM from Google offers podcast generation and study guide creation from files but its not proactive (the user must input the data) and it isn't focused on broader lifestyle support. No product currently combines calendar integration, personalized audio generation, study content delivery, and meeting transcription into a single, unified experience.

Market Opportunity

The gap Reverb addresses is structural: existing tools are built for users who have time to sit down and engage with a screen. The large and growing population of students, athletes, and professionals who are perpetually in motion (commuting, working out, getting ready, traveling) has no tool designed around their actual constraints. Podcast consumption among 18–34 year olds has grown steadily for a decade, demonstrating that this demographic is already comfortable with audio as a primary information format. Reverb simply applies that format to the information users already need to engage with: their schedule, their coursework, their meetings. Beyond format, existing tools share a second limitation: they surface information but stop short of driving action. Reverb bridges that gap by combining awareness with execution, actively guiding them through getting it done.

Features

Feature 1: Daily Audio Briefing

- Description: Every morning, Reverb generates a personalized audio briefing by pulling from the user's connected apps (Google Calendar, Gmail, Canvas, Slack, Notion, and others). The briefing covers the day's schedule, upcoming deadlines, flagged emails, and a synthesized priority stack of what the user should actually focus on today, ranked by urgency and importance. The tone is conversational and human, modeled after the cadence of a morning radio or podcast host, not a screen reader. Think “The Daily” from the New York Times but for your own life.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature 2: Study Mode (Lecture, Podcast, and Response Formats)

- Description: Users can upload course materials (syllabi, readings, lecture slides, notes) and Reverb generates on-demand audio study content in one of three formats.
 - *Lecture Mode* delivers the material as a structured solo presentation.
 - *Podcast Mode* stages a conversation between two AI hosts who discuss, debate, and unpack the content together.
 - *Response Mode* turns the session into an active recall exercise, prompting the user verbally and evaluating their spoken answers in real time with feedback and follow-up questions.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature 3: Meeting & Conversation Recording

- Description: Users can record any conversation directly within Reverb such as a professor's office hours feedback, a club meeting, a client call, a study group session. Reverb transcribes the recording, extracts key action items and takeaways, and integrates the relevant information into the next day's briefing as reminders or follow-up prompts. The full transcript is stored and searchable in the user's personal library.
- Priority: High
- Effort: Medium

Feature 4: Transcript Library & Daily One-Pager

- Description: Every transcript, uploaded document, and study session is stored in a searchable personal library within Reverb, giving users a running archive of everything they've engaged with. Alongside the audio briefing, Reverb also generates a concise daily one-pager in text, which is a clean, skimmable text summary of the day's priorities and deadlines. The one-pager is designed for the moments when a user sits down briefly and wants a fast written snapshot rather than audio.
- Priority: Medium
- Effort: Medium

Feature 5: Integration Ecosystem

- Description: Reverb connects to the tools users already use via OAuth (GCal, Gmail, Canvas, Blackboard, Notion, Slack, Outlook, and iCal). Setup takes under five minutes. Once connected, Reverb continuously pulls relevant data to keep the daily briefing current and accurate without requiring manual input from the user.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature 6: Streaks & Progress Gamification

- Description: Reverb tracks daily engagement through a lightweight gamification system based around daily streaks for listening to a briefing or completing a study session, subject mastery progress bars per course, weekly audio recaps summarizing what was covered and what's ahead, and milestone badges for first streaks, first exam prep, and first active recall session completed.
- Priority: Low
- Effort: Low

Feature 7: AI-Powered Action Stack

- Description: While the daily one-pager informs and the briefing orients, the Action Stack is where Reverb moves from awareness to execution. Using the same data pulled from the user's integrations (e.g. deadlines, calendar blocks, recorded meeting action items, and uploaded materials) Reverb generates a prioritized, actionable to-do list ranked by urgency and the user's available time. Larger tasks are automatically broken into smaller, time-bounded work blocks that fit realistically within the user's day. Throughout the day, Reverb sends smart push notifications prompting the user on what to tackle next through specific nudges to start, continue, or wrap up a defined block of work. Users can interact with the Action Stack by marking items complete, snoozing blocks, or asking Reverb to re-prioritize based on a change in their schedule.
- Priority: High
- Effort: High

Feature Prioritization

Prioritization Framework

Must-have:

- Daily Audio Briefing
- Integration Ecosystem
- Study Mode (Lecture, Podcast, Response)

Should-have:

- Meeting & Conversation Recording
- Transcript Library & Daily One-Pager
- Action Stack

Could-have:

- Streaks & Progress Gamification
- Pre-Interview / Mock Interview Mode

Prioritization Criteria

- User need: Does the feature effectively address the user's pain point?
- Impact: How much value does the feature add to the user experience?
- Feasibility: How achievable is the development of the feature within the given resources and allotted time period?
- User Feedback: Does user demand support this feature?

Prioritized Features

1. Short-form Highlight Clips (Must-have)
2. Swipe Interface (Could-Have)
3. Athlete Profiles (Should-Have)
4. Direct Messaging (Won't-Have)

Milestones

- Month 1: Market Research Completion
- Month 1-2: Integration & API Scoping
- Month 2-3: MVP Development (Briefing + 1 Integration)
- Month 4: Study Mode Development
- Month 4-5: Recording & Transcription Feature
- Month 5-6: Internal User Testing
- Month 6-7: Iteration Based on Feedback
- Month 7: Beta Launch

Metrics for Success

- Daily Active Users (DAU): Number of users playing the daily briefing on a given day
- Study Session Completion Rate: Percentage of study sessions started that are completed in full, indicating content quality and user commitment
- Streak Retention Rate: Percentage of users maintaining a 7-day streak, signaling habit formation
- Feature Adoption Rate: Percentage of active users who have used each major feature (briefing, study mode, recording) at least once
- Churn Rate: Percentage of users who stop using Reverb after the first week, indicating whether the product solves the problem well enough to retain users past initial curiosity
- Recording-to-Briefing Integration Rate: Percentage of recorded meetings that surface at least one action item in the following day's briefing, measuring whether the pipeline works end-to-end

Conclusion

Reverb addresses a structural gap in how students and professionals manage information and learning. Existing tools assume focused screen time that most users don't have, but Reverb is built for the reality of lives already in motion. By delivering personalized audio across a daily briefing, adaptive study formats, and integrated meeting transcription, Reverb turns the dead time in any day into productive hours. The immediate target users are college students and student athletes, with a natural expansion path toward busy professionals. The initial scope is deliberately focused on the briefing, the study modes, and the recording pipeline, with a clear roadmap for the collaborative and advanced features that follow.